

Welcome to Bureau of Immigration.

The authentic gateway to the latest travel regulations, visa policies, and immigration services.

Established in 1971, the Bureau of Immigration (BoI) operates under the leadership of Commissioner of Immigration. BoI is the primary authority responsible for enforcing the latest rules and regulations governing the entry, stay and exit of foreign nationals in India. Through the network of FRROs and CHIOs, BoI manages immigration facilities across India's International Check Posts (ICPs).

BoI ensures smooth, secure and efficient immigration process for travelers arriving in or departing from India. BoI also oversees registration services and visa- related formalities for foreign nationals residing in India in accordance with relevant Acts, Rules and Regulations

Vision & Mission

Vision : To develop a professional, effective and efficient Immigration service for facilitating legitimate travellers, while ensuring national security.

Mission : To enforce Indian laws with integrity and strive to achieve the highest standards in the duties we perform, the professionalism we display and the service we render with the overall objective of facilitating legitimate travellers without compromising national security.

Tourism in India

Guided by the timeless ethos of "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam"- the world is one family, India stands at the crossroads of ancient wisdom and modern vibrancy. India's deep rooted traditions of harmony, diversity, yoga, ayurveda and non-violence continue to shape India's global identity and inspire travellers from every corner of the world.

Today, India is one of the world's most compelling travel destinations- where culture meets innovation and heritage blends seamlessly with contemporary experiences. From world-class business hubs to breathtaking landscapes and immersive culture journeys, India offers travellers a wealth of unforgettable moments.

News Center – Latest Updates on Travel

To stay updated on important developments, advisories and information relevant to Indian Citizens travelling abroad, please visit our News Center.

Immigration > About Us > Vision & Mission

Vision & Mission

Vision

A professional, effective and efficient Immigration service for facilitating legitimate travellers, while ensuring national security.

Mission

To enforce Indian laws with integrity and strive to achieve the highest standards in the duties we perform, the professionalism we display and the service we render with the overall objective of facilitating legitimate travelers without compromising national security.

Values

Our core values are the guiding beacons for all that we do and provide us the benchmark for assessing our performance.

Integrity: To maintain high standards of integrity and professionalism through uniform application of laws and policies.

Courtesy: To treat each member of the public with respect, courtesy and compassion.

Dynamism: To respond positively to the ever-changing socio-politico-economic environment and to realign strategies to meet new challenges.

Excellence: To continuously strive for excellence in whatever we do and seek to create a benchmark for Immigration services worldwide.

Innovation: To encourage new ideas, methods, processes and practices.

Collaboration: To work together with other stakeholders to achieve common goals
(Any suitable photo)

Role of Immigration

Control and regulate entry and exit of all persons at our Airports, Seaports, Rail, River and Land Check posts.

Control and Regulating Stay of Foreigners by ensuring Registration formalities, renewal of visas etc.

To identify and take legal action against illegal immigrants

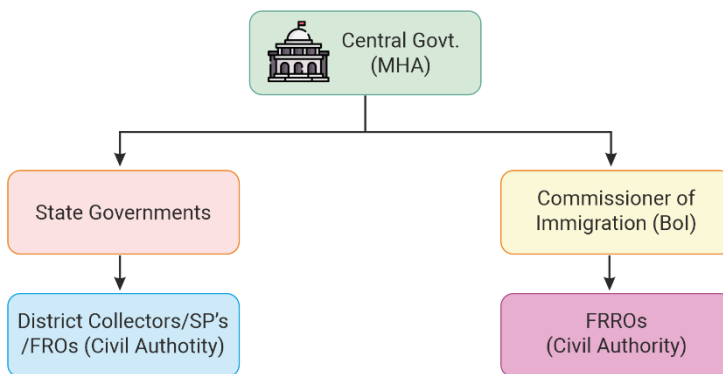
To identify and remove persons who contravenes the immigration Laws and Regulations

Prevention and detection of human trafficking.

Prevention and detection of fraudulent documents and Imposters.

About us

Delegation of Powers



Bureau of Immigration (BoI) was set up in 1971. It's headed by Commissioner of Immigration. FRROs & ChIOs handle Immigration services at the various Immigration Check Posts (ICPs) in India. BoI is responsible for Immigration services at various ICPs along with the Registration formalities and Visa Services of foreigners residing in India in accordance with extant Acts, Rules and Regulations.

Altogether, there are 114 Immigration Check Posts (Air/ Sea/Land/Rail/ River) in India, catering to international traffic. There are 15 FRROs (Foreigners Regional Registration Officer) located at Ahmedabad, Amritsar, Bangalore, Calicut, Chandigarh, Chennai, Cochin, Delhi, Guwahati, Hyderabad, Jaipur, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai, Trivandrum. Apart from this, there are 24 Chief Immigration Officers functioning in Goa, Jaipur, Gaya, Varanasi, Nagpur, Pune, Indore, Mangalore, Trichy, Coimbatore, Bagdogra, Chandigarh, Haridaspur, Kannur, Dera Baba Nanak, Raxaul, Sonauli, Gede, Munabao, Chitpur, Guwahati, New Jalpaiguri, Dhamra & Mopa. At remaining places District Superintendent of Police (SPs) are the FROs (Foreigners Registration Officers) to facilitate emergency cases of foreigners.

Immigration >Policy and Law >Immigration Policies & Process

Acts, Rules & Orders

Acts, Rules, Orders & Notifications regarding Foreigners

All foreign nationals in India & all persons travelling from/ to India are governed by the provisions contained in the below mentioned Acts, Rules and Orders made there under.

The Immigration & Foreigners Act 2025: The Act regulates immigration, entry, and stay of foreigners in India. It also regulates Registration of Foreigners in India, Liability of Carriers, and Obligations of keeper of accommodation and others to furnish particulars.

It repeals the following Acts: (i) The Passport (Entry into India) Act, 1920, (ii) the Registration of Foreigners Act, 1939, (iii) The Foreigners Act 1946, and (iv) The Immigration (Carriers' Liability) Act, 2000.

Immigration & Foreigners Rules 2025: The rules made under Immigration and Foreigners Act 2025, consolidate and modernize the regulations governing entry, stay and exit of foreign nationals in India.

Immigration & Foreigners Order 2025: The Order made in exercise of the powers conferred by the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025 and in supersession of the Foreigners Order, 1948, the Foreigners (Protected Areas) Order, 1958, the Foreigners (Restricted Areas) Order, 1963 and the Foreigners (Tribunals) Order, 1964.

The Order regulates entry into, stay in, movement within and exit from India. Further, it regulates restriction of certain activities of foreigners, prevention, detention, restricting movements and deportation of Illegal migrants. It also deals with Protected & Restricted Areas, Foreigners Tribunals and Prohibited Places.

The Citizenship Act, 1955: It regulates acquisition and termination of Indian citizenship as well as Overseas Citizens of India.

Passports Act, 1967: The Act guides on the issue of passports and travel documents, to regulate the departure of Citizens of India and other persons, and for matters incidental or ancillary thereto.

Further Acts, Rules and Regulations pertaining to Foreigners may be referred at the website of Foreigners Division, Ministry of Home Affairs (www.mha.gov.in).

Immigration Fraud

Immigration fraud is an offence under the Immigration & Foreigners Act, 2025. We have wide-ranging measures to detect and prevent immigration offences.

Immigration fraud includes but not limited to the following offences:

Using a false or altered document to support a visa application, for example Passport, Identity documents etc.

Providing false or misleading information to support a visa application.

Helping someone to come to or stay in India who you know either does not have a Visa or does not have the appropriate Visa.

Helping someone to come to India by deceiving them on the purpose of their stay in India or your reasons for bringing them to India.

Using forged or fraudulently obtained travel documents to depart the country or seek entry.

The Government of India has designated 28 Immigration Check Posts (ICPs) across the country, each under the jurisdiction of a respective Foreign Regional Registration Office (FRRO).

Ahmedabad in Gujarat is under FRRO Ahmedabad, while Lucknow and Varanasi, both in Uttar Pradesh, are controlled by FRRO Lucknow. Amritsar in Punjab falls under FRRO Amritsar, which also oversees Chandigarh in Haryana. Bagdogra in West Bengal, along with Gaya in Bihar and Guwahati in Assam, are all administered by FRRO Kolkata, which additionally governs Kolkata itself.

Bangalore in Karnataka is under FRRO Bangalore, which also controls Mangalore. In Kerala, Calicut and Kannur are under FRRO Calicut, Cochin has its own FRRO, and Trivandrum is governed by FRRO Trivandrum. Chennai in Tamil Nadu is under FRRO Chennai, which also oversees Coimbatore and Trichy.

Delhi, being the National Capital Territory, is under FRRO Delhi, which additionally controls Jaipur in Rajasthan. Hyderabad in Telangana is governed by FRRO Hyderabad. Mumbai in Maharashtra falls under FRRO Mumbai, which has the widest jurisdiction — also covering Dabolim and Manohar International Airport, Mopa in Goa, Indore and Raja Bhoj International Airport in Bhopal (both in Madhya Pradesh), as well as Nagpur and Pune in Maharashtra.

The Government of India has designated 21 Immigration Check Posts (ICPs) at various seaports and waterways across the country, each under the jurisdiction of a respective Foreign Regional Registration Office (FRRO).

In Kerala, Calicut is under FRRO Calicut; Cochin governs both Cochin port and Vallarpadam; while FRRO Trivandrum oversees Kovalam-Vizhinjam, Kollam, and the newly developed Vizhinjam International Seaport. Chennai in Tamil Nadu is under FRRO Chennai, which also administers Kattupalli. FRRO Mumbai holds the broadest jurisdiction among seaports, covering Mumbai, Mormugao Harbour in Goa, and Nhava Sheva / Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Maharashtra. New Mangalore in Karnataka falls under FRRO Bangalore, and Dhamra in Odisha is governed by FRRO Hyderabad. In Gujarat, both Kandla and Mundra are under FRRO Ahmedabad.

However, the controlling authority has not yet been specified for five ICPs — Karimganj, Pandu, Dhubri, and Silghat, all in Assam, as well as Kamarajar in Tamil Nadu — indicating that their jurisdictional assignments may be pending or yet to be notified.

The Government of India has designated 12 Immigration Check Posts (ICPs) at various land border crossings across the country, each under the jurisdiction of a respective Foreign Regional Registration Office (FRRO).

In Punjab, Attari Road and Dera Baba Nanak (Kartarpur) are both administered by FRRO Amritsar. FRRO Kolkata holds the widest jurisdiction among land border ICPs, overseeing Agartala in Tripura, Haridaspur, Jaigoan, Gede, and Ghojadanga in West Bengal, Moreh in Manipur, and Raxaul in Bihar. In Uttar Pradesh, both Sonauli and Rupaidiha fall under FRRO Lucknow.

However, the controlling authority has not yet been specified for Darranga in Assam, indicating that its jurisdictional assignment may be pending or yet to be notified.

The Government of India has designated 6 Immigration Check Posts (ICPs) at various rail and road border crossings, each under the jurisdiction of a respective Foreign Regional Registration Office (FRRO).

FRRO Kolkata holds the widest jurisdiction, overseeing four ICPs — Petrapole/Chitpur, Gede Rail and Road Check Post, Haridaspur, and New Jalpaiguri Railway Station, all located in West Bengal. Attari in Amritsar, Punjab, is administered by FRRO Amritsar. Munabao in Rajasthan falls under the jurisdiction of FRRO Delhi.

Health Regulation

Any person arriving from or Transiting from a Yellow fever endemic area/country by Air/Sea has to be in possession of a valid Yellow Fever Vaccination Certificate as per the prescribed norms laid down by WHO.

Foreigners or Indians (excluding infants below six months) arriving by air or sea without a Yellow Fever Vaccination Certificate will be kept in quarantine for a period up to 6 days if they have visited or transited from a Yellow Fever endemic area.

There is no health check requirement for leaving India to Yellow Fever endemic countries, however passengers are advised in their own interest to get themselves vaccinated and to be in possession of valid yellow fever vaccination certificates before they leave the country.

Generally Indian Missions issues visas to Foreign nationals applying from Yellow fever endemic countries only after the production of a valid vaccination certificate of Yellow Fever and an endorsement "Valid Yellow Fever Vaccination Certificate Checked" is made on the visa of the foreigner.

Notified Yellow Fever Endemic Countries:

Africa (30 Countries):

Angola, Benin, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cameroon, Central African Republic, Chad, Congo, Cote d' Ivoire, Democratic Republic of Congo, Equatorial Guinea, Ethiopia, Gabon, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Guinea Bissau, Kenya, Liberia, Mali, Mauritania, Niger, Nigeria, Rwanda, Senegal, Sierra Leone, Sudan, South Sudan, Togo, Uganda.

South America (13 Countries):

Argentina, Bolivia, Brazil, Colombia, Ecuador, French Guyana, Guyana, Suriname, Trinidad (Trinidad only), Venezuela, Panama, Paraguay, Peru.

For further details visit ihpoe.mohfw.gov.in

Identity Information

The Immigration and Foreigners Order 2025, regulates the capturing of biometric information as mentioned below:

(1) Every foreigner applying for any category of visa, including registration as Overseas Citizen of India Cardholder under section 7A of the Citizenship Act, 1955 (57 of 1955), shall allow his biometric information to be taken by the authority issuing the visa or the authority granting the registration as Overseas Citizen of India Cardholder, as the case may be, before grant of such visa or registration as Overseas Citizen of India cardholder.

(2) A person who is identified as a foreigner or considered to be a foreigner while in India shall allow his biometric information to be taken at such time and at such place by: -

(a) a specified authority of the State Government or a Union territory Administration;

(b) Civil authority;

(c) Registration Officer;

(d) Immigration Officer;

(e) Border Guarding Forces; or

(f) Coast Guard,

on the designated electronic portal of the Central Government for the purpose.

(3) The biometric information shall be taken as per specifications specified by the Central Government from time to time.

(4) The biometric information captured shall be valid for ten years from the date of capturing.

(5) The foreigners who do not have fingerprints or poor fingerprints shall be exempted and only facial traits or iris shall be captured for them.

(6) The foreigner who is having less number of fingers shall give fingerprints of existing fingers only.

For more details kindly visit Ministry of Home Affairs website at www.mha.gov.in

Obligation of Carriers

Obligation of carrier to provide certain information:

(1) The country representative or station manager of an airline departing or embarking from India to an airport outside India, arriving or landing in India from an airport outside India, shall provide the following information to the civil authority or the Immigration Officer, namely:

(a) The passenger and crew manifest in Form V;

(b) Advance passenger information data of passengers on board and crew, within fifteen minutes of leaving or wheels-off of the aircraft from the port of embarkation outside India, and after closure of boarding or wheels-off the aircraft from the port of embarkation within India, as per International Civil Aviation Organisation Annex-9 (Facilitation) data fields and data format UNEDIFACT-PAXLST including passenger information (Name, Gender, Date of Birth and Nationality) and travel document information of passport and visa (type, number, date of issue and expiry), flight and journey information;

(c) Passenger name record data of passengers for arrival in India or for departure from India at T-72 hours, at T-24 hours, at T-08 hours and at T-0 hours, where T is the scheduled time of arrival in India or departure from India, as the case may be, as

per International Civil Aviation Organisation Annex-9 (Facilitation) data fields and data format UNEDIFACT-PNRGOV including passenger information (Name, Gender, Date of Birth and Nationality), travel document information of passport and visa (type, number, date of issue and expiry), travel and payment information, flight and journey information.

(2) The country representative or master of a vessel (cargo or cruise or general movement chartered ships) departing or embarking from India to a port or place outside India and arriving or berthing in India from a port or place outside India shall provide the passenger manifest and crew manifest as in Form VI at T-72 hours, where T is the scheduled time of arrival in India or departure from India, as the case may be, to the civil authority or the Immigration Officer.

Liability of carrier to furnish information: Every carrier shall, when required, provide information to the District Magistrate or Commissioner of Police or, where there is no Commissioner of Police, Superintendent of Police or the civil authority or the Immigration Officer, of passenger and crew manifest in Form V or Form VI, as the case may be.

General Declaration furnished by carrier to Immigration Officer:

(1) Every carrier shall submit a general declaration to the Immigration Officer in Form VIII prior to the departure of the flight, vessel or other mode of transport at D-45 minutes, where D is the scheduled departure time.

(2) No flight or vessel or other mode of transport shall be permitted by the carrier to depart from a port or place in India until the Immigration Officer has given clearance on such general declaration.

Queries/clarifications: Queries on the technical aspects of APIS implementation may be addressed to [apisindia\[at\]nic\[dot\]in](mailto:apisindia@nic.in) and on the administrative aspects, may be addressed to [frrodli\[at\]nic\[at\]in](mailto:frrodli@nic.in).

Important PDFs regarding APIS :-

Immigration and Foreigners Rules,2025(967 KB)

APIS Guidelines to the Carriers (155 KB)

FAQs (181 KB)

Time Limit for compliance with APIS(11KB)

Immigration

Indian Citizenship > Surrender of Indian Citizenship

Renunciation/Surrendering of Indian Citizenship

Indian Citizenship Act does not provide for dual citizenship. As per the Passport Act, it is mandatory for all Indian passport holders to surrender their last Indian passport to the Consulate or Regional Passport office (RPO) in India immediately after acquisition of foreign nationality.

It is an offence under the Citizenship Act and the Passports Act for foreign nationals to hold Indian passports. Once Indian passport is surrendered, Consulate/ RPO will cancel and return it to the Passport holder along with Renunciation/Surrender certificate.

For information on surrendering of Indian Passport please visit www.passportindia.gov.in

Those who have acquired foreign nationality after 01.06.2010 may apply for Renunciation Certificate online on the Ministry of Home Affairs (Foreigners Division) website

<https://indiancitizenshiponline.nic.in/Renounce>

Note: On surrender of Indian Passport, Indian Voter ID Card/Election Photo ID Card (EPIC Card) needs to be surrendered and in case of Ration Card the record needs to be removed by contacting the concerned authority.

Visa & OCI> Apply for Visa >List of Visas

LIST OF VISAS

Sl.

No Main

category of

Visa Specified

as Sub

Categories	Description	Remarks
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1 Business Visa B B-1 For all business activities (Other than those covered by B-2, B-3 and B-4 Visas) including Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) activities of aircrafts and ships -

B-2 For sports persons and coaches including those engaged in commercial sports events in India on contract with remuneration -

B-3 Visa for foreign nationals coming to India for participation in cultural/commercial performances of concerts and also for those involved in performative arts like acting, dance, etc -

B-4 Production Investment Business Visa Granted only on e-Visa platform

B-5 Conference For attending international conferences/seminars/workshops

B-6 Film For foreign nationals coming for shooting of feature films, reality TV & Web shows/series and for location recce.

PRS Permanent Residency Status for foreign investors -

2 Diplomatic Visa D D-1 Diplomats assigned in India (on Diplomatic Passport only) -

D-2 Diplomat on a visit to India for meetings and other official purposes (on Diplomatic Passport) -

D-3 Diplomats assigned to Non-UN International Organization (such as ADB, ICRIAT, ICRC etc.) in India -

D-4 UN Diplomat assigned to India -

D-5 UN Diplomat on a visit to India -

D-1X

D-2X

D-3X

D-4X

D-5X For dependents For dependents of D-1, D-2, D-3, D-4 and D-5 Visa holders respectively

3 Work Visa E E-1 All cases of employment (including intra company transferees) but excluding those covered by E-2 and E-3 Visas -

E-2 For employment in NGOs -

E-3 For Missionary/ Religious worker of Approved organizations -

4 Family Visa F - For dependents of various visa category holders (other than dependents of Diplomatic/Official Visa holders) -

5 Journalist Visa J J-1 For journalists accredited in India and also for journalists visiting India for any purpose including tourism, conference etc. -

J-2 Foreign nationals coming for shooting of advertisement/documentary films etc. -

6 Medical Visa M M-1 Foreign nationals coming for medical treatment (other than those under Ayush systems) -

M-2 For Medical Attendants of those coming under M-1 Visa -

M-3 Foreign nationals coming for treatment under Ayush systems-

M-4 For attendants of those coming on M-3 Visa -

7 Official Visa O O-1 Non- diplomatic official assigned to a diplomatic Mission in India (On Official/ Service/ Special Passport only) -

O-2 Non -diplomatic official on a visit to India for official purpose -

O-3 UN Non – Diplomatic official assigned to India -

O-4 UN Non – Diplomatic official on a visit to India -

O-1X

O-2X

O-3X

O-4X For dependents For dependents of O-1, O-2, O-3 and O-4 Visa holders respectively

8 Pakistan Specific Visas P P-1 Visitor Visa for Pakistan nationals coming to visit relatives or friends or for any other legitimate purpose -

P-2 Pilgrim Visa for Pakistan nationals coming under Religious Protocol -

P-3 Group Pilgrim visa for minority communities in Pakistan -

9 Student Visa S S-1 For higher education (including in South Asian University and Nalanda University), provisional student visa, for short term courses, for those coming under Student Exchange Programme, for those coming to pursue education, training and skill development in Ayush practices, for higher education in Theological studies.

S-2 For school education

S-3 For studies in Yoga, Vedic Culture and Indian systems of Music and Dance, for Buddhist studies, programs and courses on Indian languages and Indian knowledge system.

S-4 For research scholar, visiting research faculty, research scholar on bilateral exchange programme, members of Botanical, Scientific, Anthropological etc. Expeditions and G-20 Talent Visa. -

S-5 For those coming for Internship in India -

10 Tourist Visa T T-1 For recreation, sightseeing, casual visit to meet friends or relatives, attending a short term yoga programme, short duration medical treatment including treatment under Ayush systems (other than for treatment which are pre-planned), short term courses on local languages, music, dance, arts & crafts, cooking, medicine etc. which should not be a formal or structured course/programme (courses not exceeding 6 months duration and not issued with a qualifying certificate/ diploma etc.), and voluntary work of short duration (for a maximum period

of one month, which do not involve any monetary payment or consideration of any kind in return). etc. and no other-purpose/ activity.

T-2 For foreign nationals coming for mountaineering expeditions -

11 Transit Visa TR - For travelling through India to a destination outside India -

12 Miscellaneous Visa X X-1 For persons of Indian Origin and foreign spouse & foreign children of an Indian citizens/ Person of Indian Origin/ OCI cardholder (other than those registered as OCI cardholder) -

X-2 For those coming to join Auroville Foundation, Aurobindo Ashram, Missionaries of Charity, temples or similar approved organizations, foreign Buddhist Monks coming to join Buddhist Monasteries/ other Buddhist organizations for charity work. -

X-3 Double Entry visa for Bangladeshi nationals coming to India to apply for a visa in foreign missions accredited to both India and Bangladesh. -

X-4 Stay visa for Afghan Nationals -

X-Misc For purposes which are not covered by any other visa category -

13 Long term Visa LTV - For certain categories of Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Pakistan nationals.

How to apply?

Procedure for applying for Regular Visa/ eVisa.

The foreign national may fill in the application online on the website <https://indianvisaonline.gov.in>

Advisory:

Government of India has not authorized any agent or intermediary to charge any fee for facilitation of emergency / express Visa/eVisa.

For travel to India a regular/eVisa along with passport is mandatory.

Only categories exempted under bilateral arrangements may not need a visa.

Visa is not required for OCI Card holders.

Extending stay on Your Visa

Foreign Nationals who are unable to leave/ exit India within the validity of their visa due to justifiable reasons, should apply for the appropriate visa service on

<https://indianfrro.gov.in>.

Such visa services are available only to foreign nationals who are present in India.

This request/ application should be made within the validity of their current visa, allowing reasonable time for processing.

If the extension/ conversion of the visa/ permission to continue their stay is not granted within the validity of their current visa, they must depart from India. Failure to depart will be considered a willful illegal overstay and will be treated in accordance with the law.

Conversion of Your Visa Type

For converting your Visa type, kindly make an application with your jurisdictional FRRO at

<https://indianfrro.gov.in/eservices/home.jsp>

For more details refer to Registration Authority section on this website.

About PIO/OCI Card

Important Guidelines

OCI FAQ

OVERSEAS CITIZEN OF INDIA (OCI) CARDHOLDER

The Government of India had introduced the Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) Card and Person of Indian Origin (PIO) Card Scheme to benefit the Indian Diasporas in terms of connectivity with the motherland, hassle free travel to India, friendly investment regime and benefits in social, economic and educational fields.

Who is an Overseas Citizen of India Cardholder?

A person is said to be an “Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) Cardholder” if he/she is registered by the Government of India, under Section 7A of The Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2015.

Eligibility for registration as an OCI Cardholder

Following categories of foreign nationals (except few categories) are eligible for registration as Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) Cardholder

Any person of full age and capacity:

Who is a citizen of another country, but was a citizen of India at the time of, or at any time after 26.01.1950; or

Who is a citizen of another country, but was eligible to become a citizen of India as on 26.01.1950; or

Who is a citizen of another country, but belonged to a territory that became part of India after 15.08.1947; or

Who is a child or a grandchild or a great grandchild of such a citizen; or

A person, who is a minor child of a person mentioned above; or

A person, who is a minor child, and whose both parents are citizens of India or one of the parents is a citizen of India; or

Spouse of foreign origin of a citizen of India or spouse of foreign origin of an OCI cardholder, whose marriage has been registered and subsisted for a continuous period of not less than two years immediately preceding the presentation of the application.

Children born out of live-in relationship and IVF/Surrogacy are eligible for registration on case-to-case basis subject to merits of the case.

Who are not eligible for registration as an OCI cardholder?

No person, who or either of whose parents or grandparents or great grandparents is or had been a citizen of Pakistan, Bangladesh or such other country as notified by Government of India, shall be eligible for registration as OCI cardholder.

Foreign Military/Police Personnel (except Israelis) either serving or retired will not be registered as OCI cardholder.

Foreign nationals who are undergoing compulsory military/police conscription at the time of application will not be eligible for registration during the period of such conscription.

Foreign nationals, who are applying for OCI card on spouse basis, shall not be eligible if they have undergone/undergoing any military/police conscription.

A foreign national holding Diplomatic Passport will not be registered as OCI cardholder.

Merger of Persons of Indian Origin (PIO) Scheme with OCI

The erstwhile Person of Indian Origin (PIO) card scheme has been rescinded by the Government of India and all the existing PIO cardholders shall be deemed to be Overseas Indian Citizens of India (OCI) cardholders. However, all persons who are

still holding PIO cards are advised to apply for conversion of their PIO cards into OCI card through OCI Miscellaneous Services.

Surrender/Cancellation of OCI Card

If the foreigner gets remarried to another foreigner/Indian, he/she should surrender the existing OCI card to the concerned FRRO/Indian Mission.

If it is found that the registration as an OCI Cardholder was obtained by means of fraud, false representation or concealment of any material fact or the registered OCI Cardholder has shown disaffection towards the Constitution of India or contravened any provisions of the Citizenship Act, 1955, the registration of such person will be cancelled forthwith.

Please visit the website <https://ociservices.gov.in> or visit the nearest Indian Mission/FRRO for more details

Important Guidelines for OCI Cardholders

Passport is the primary travel document. OCI is only a life-long visa. (OCI card issued to spouse of Indian/ Indian origin on or after 03.09.2025 will have an initial validity of 5 years, which is further extendable to lifelong subject to scrutiny)

Stay of foreigners in India without a valid passport is illegal even if he or she is an OCI cardholder. Hence, it is necessary that OCI cardholders staying in India should be in possession of a valid passport and OCI card at all times of his/her stay in the country .

Foreigners registered as OCI Cardholders and staying in India are exempted from the requirement of Registration with jurisdictional FRROs.

The 'U' (Universal) visa sticker on the foreign passport of OCI cardholders is dispensed with.

Foreigners who intend to submit their applications for registration as OCI cardholder to a jurisdictional FRRO in India, should be 'Ordinarily Resident ', which meanshe/she should stay in India for a continuous period of 6 months .

In such cases, a copy of any long duration visa (other than Tourist, Missionary, Mountaineering Visa) with 3 months validity as on the date of application along with Registration Certificate (RC/RP) issued by FRRO/FRO should be submitted along with the application mandatorily.

Capturing of biometrics of fingerprints & face (if technically feasible) in case of applicants for registration as OCI cardholders is mandatory.

In case the Birth/Marriage Certificate is issued by a foreign authority, it is to be Apostled or endorsed by the concerned Indian Mission abroad/concerned foreign Mission in India.

An OCI cardholder staying in India, who require a Police Clearance Certificate (PCC) shall apply for such certificate to the FRRO/FRO concerned as per their place of residence indicating the purpose for which such PCC is required. For applying, please visit <https://indianfro.gov.in>

OCI Cardholders shall also require Protected Area/Restricted Area Permit (RAP/PAP) to visit any place which falls within the Protected/Restricted Area as notified by the Government of India. For more info, please check the 'Entry to Restricted/Protected Areas' page on this website

Frequently Asked Questions

1. Which territories became part of India after 15.08.1947?

Name of the Territory

w.e.f

Dadra & Nagar Haveli

11.08.1961

Goa, Daman and Diu

20.12.1961

Puducherry

16.08.1962

Sikkim

26.04.1975

2. How to submit the OCI applications?

Applications for registration as OCI Cardholders are to be submitted online. For further information on applications and documents to be submitted, please visit <https://ociservices.gov.in>

3. Whether applicants are required to submit hard copies of the applications to the concerned FRRO?

After submitting the application online, foreigners are required to bring the originals of uploaded documents for verification.

4. Are foreigners required to attend a personal interview at the Indian Mission/ FRRO concerned?

Yes. If a foreigner applies for new registration as OCI cardholder, personal interview is mandatory. However, children below 12 years of age are exempted from personal interview.

5. Am I required to provide my biometrics during registration as OCI Cardholder?

In case of applications for registration as OCI cardholders submitted to Indian Missions/Posts abroad, the applicants will have the option of giving biometrics at the application stage or at the Immigration Check Posts on arrival in India. However, they are advised to give biometrics at the application stage itself.

In respect of applications submitted to FRROs in India, biometrics shall be captured at the application stage itself.

6. Who are exempted from providing biometrics?

Applicants above 70 years of age or below 12 years of age would be exempted from biometric capturing.

7. Are children (foreigners) of such Indian national who is not alive entitled for registration as OCI Cardholder?

Yes.

8. How to collect the OCI Card?

In order to collect the OCI Card, the applicant is required to be present at the concerned Indian Mission/FRRO in person or he/she can send a duly authorized person, along with his/her passport for this purpose. However, the applicant should be physically present in the country of issuance of OCI card when it is collected by the authorized person.

9. Will the fee be refunded, in case the registration as OCI Cardholder is not granted?

An amount of USD 250 or equivalent in local currency shall be refunded in case the registration as OCI Cardholder is not granted. However, the processing fees of USD 25 or Rs. 1400/- (in India) is non-refundable.

10. Does the applicant lose his Citizenship in case he is registered as an OCI Cardholder?

No.

11. Can foreign diplomatic and official passport holders not assigned in India travel on the strength of their OCI cards?

Yes.

12. Who is an 'Ordinarily Resident'?

An 'Ordinarily Resident' is a person staying in a particular country or in India for a continuous period of 6 months.

13. Can a OCI Cardholder vote in India?

The OCI Cardholder is not entitled to vote.

14. Is an OCI Cardholder entitled for Constitutional Posts in India?

OCI Cardholders cannot be a member of Legislative Assembly, or Legislative Council or Parliament, cannot hold Constitutional posts such as President, Vice-President, Judge of the Supreme Court or High Court etc.

15. Are OCI Cardholders entitled for appointment to public services and posts in India?

No. For further information, contact the concerned Indian Mission/FRRO.

16. Can OCI Cardholders acquire agricultural or plantation properties in India?

No.

17. Can OCI Cardholder appear for any entrance exams for Indian Educational Institutions?

OCI Cardholders are eligible for appearing for all the Indian entrance tests such as National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET), Joint Entrance Examination (Mains), Joint Entrance Examination (Advanced), All India Pre Medical Test or such other tests. Provided that the OCI cardholder shall not be eligible for admission against any seat reserved exclusively for Indian citizens.

Travelling to India

General Guidelines

General Guidelines for those travelling to India

The Citizens of India as well as foreigners are required to obtain Immigration clearance both at the time of arrival as well as departure to/from India.

Grant of an Indian Visa/Visa Free Regime does not confer the right of entry which is subjected to the discretion of Immigration Authorities.

Foreigner must complete and submit the e-Arrival card online within 72 hours before their arrival in India at <https://indianvisaonline.gov.in/earrival> or via official Indian Visa Su-Swagatam mobile app.

Pakistani nationals can arrive by Air only at Delhi, Mumbai and Chennai ICPs.

Foreigners except certain categories who are travelling to India are required to hold a valid passport and valid visa. Certain foreigners may for one reason or another, travel on travel documents other than a proper national passport, or a Certificate of Identity. Such foreigners are required to hold a valid visa for entry into India.

After due checks and capture of biometrics (in case if required), the passports will be duly stamped.

It is one's responsibility to make sure that the Arrival/Departure seals get affixed on their passports. In case one misses to get their Passport affixed by us, please get in touch with the nearest FRRO or Immigration Post to make sure the seal gets affixed and enjoy a hassle-free travel.

Foreigners who are granted a particular type of visa with reference to the purpose of visit shall be required to strictly adhere to the purpose of visit declared while submitting the visa application.

Indians traveling from Nepal by Air are required to carry either a valid Indian passport or Original Indian Voter ID card with photograph issued by the Election Commission of India.

Foreigner granted any type of visa and OCI cards shall not be permitted to engage themselves in preaching religious ideologies, making speeches in religious places, distribution of audio or visual display/pamphlets pertaining to religious ideologies, spreading conversion etc. will not be allowed.

Persons from Yellow Fever (YF) endemic countries (or if he/she has visited any Yellow Fever (YF) endemic country during past 6 days) will be required to possess a valid certificate of Yellow Fever vaccination from an authorized vaccination centre.

If a person or attendant/ family members of the person is arriving from a country which is having public health risk with regard to any condition which has been declared as public health emergency of international concern (PHEIC) by WHO DG, then he/ she may be required to undergo medical screening or additional measures as decided by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare. For more details about health regulations, please

Airlines Crew

Seamen

Air Crew

Crew members of scheduled/ non-scheduled flights operated by scheduled airlines, non-scheduled and chartered flights operated by non-scheduled airlines and special flights are required to obtain Business/e-Business visa for appropriate duration.

Travel Documents for Crew:

Air crew members of scheduled airlines who operate scheduled services to, or through, India can enter India with the valid 'Crew Member Certificate' or 'License' issued by the country of registration of the aircraft in lieu of passport.

In all cases of crew of non-scheduled airlines, chartered flights operated by such airlines and Special flights, visa should be endorsed on their national passport only and NOT on the crew member certificate.

Guidelines for Pakistan Air Crew:

The Air Crew of Pakistan operating the scheduled services between India and Pakistan will be allowed to land at the designated airports in India, without being required to be in possession of passports and visas, provided they hold valid personnel licenses.

Aircraft Maintenance Engineers/Staff of the Airlines of Pakistan who are required to travel to India in connection with repairs or maintenance of the aircraft with/without notice in case of emergencies, will be given facilities to land in the airport concerned up to a period of 36 (thirty-six) hours without visas, provided they hold valid passports endorsed for India and are in possession of appropriate Aircraft Maintenance Engineers Licenses.

Air Crew of Pakistan stationed in India will be subject to the requirements of registration, report on arrival/departure etc., within 24 hours.

Pakistani and Pakistani origin crew members will not be issued with Landing Permit if they are arriving from a country other than Pakistan

Business in India

Foreigners who intend to visit India to establish an industrial/business venture or to explore possibilities to set up an industrial firm/company (or) to attend technical meetings/discussions, board/general meetings for providing business services support, for Consultations and other business-related activities should arrive on a Business visa.

Foreigners who are engaged in commercial sports events on contract (including coaches) like Indian Premier League, Indian Super League and Indian Badminton League etc., with remuneration are also required to be on a Business visa.

Important Guidelines:

All Business Visa holders are required to register themselves with the FRRO/FRO concerned in case the aggregate stay in India on any Visa exceeds 180 days during a calendar year.

Business visa shall be extended only if the gross sales/turnover from the business activities, for which the foreigner has been granted visa, is not less than Rs. 1 crore per annum (to be achieved within 4 years of setting up of the business or from the date of initial grant of B visa, whichever is earlier).

If the extension of Visa is denied, the foreigner shall leave India forthwith or expiry of the period of validity of the Visa.

Foreigner should comply with all taxation rules pertaining to his business in India.

Foreign national in India on Business visa cannot take any salary/ remuneration in India. If the foreign national is taking salary/ remuneration in India, he must come on an Employment Visa.

Foreigner should be with company/ organization for which Visa reference has been made while obtaining the Business Visa.

Medical Treatment in India

If a foreigner wishes to seek medical treatment in any of the established/recognized/specialized hospitals or any treatment centres providing medical treatment under the Indian systems of medicine, accredited by the Government of India, must arrive on a Medical Visa. Such Foreigners who accompany the patients or Medical Visa holders should arrive on a Medical Attendant visa.

Country-Specific Guidelines:

Not more than two persons shall be given Medical Attendant visas in case of foreign nationals other than Pakistan and Bangladesh nationals.

Only one medical attendant shall be allowed in case of Pak nationals.

Three medical attendants shall be allowed in case of Bangladesh nationals.

Pak nationals holding Medical/Medical Attendant visas are required to register themselves with concerned FRO within 24 hours of their arrival in India.

Key points to remember:

Change of hospital/Place of treatment (endorsed on initial visa) shall be permitted only on case-to-case basis, subject to production of documentary proof justifying such change.

Foreigners (other than Pak nationals) whose Medical/Medical Attendant visas are valid for more than 180 days should register themselves within 14 days of their arrival in India.

Study in India

Foreigners shall obtain an appropriate Student Visa if their objective is to pursue on-campus, full time structured courses or Research in any of the educational institutions duly recognized by the Government of India.

Foreigners who intend to study yoga, Vedic culture, Indian system of dance, music or Buddhist studies etc., at the institutions approved by Government of India are required to hold a Student (S-3) Visa.

Foreigners arriving in India to pursue internship in Indian companies, educational institutions, NGOs, foreign missions/posts in India and foreign Government Organizations are required to obtain a Student (S-6) Visa.

Important Guidelines:

Foreigners who wish to apply to top Indian institutes which offer courses can register themselves for Study In India (SII) scheme. For more details, please visit <https://studyinindia.gov.in>

Foreigners must ensure that they are not enrolled into any courses offered by franchise Educational Institutes running off-campus centres, Study Centres of Open Universities offering distance learning programmes, Educational Institutes running “outreach” programmes.

Foreign students are required to open Non-Resident Ordinary (NRO) Account in any of the recognized banks in India and the details to be furnished to the FRRO concerned.

Foreigners on Student visa are must not involve in any Employment/Business activities in India.

Foreign nationals (except Pak nationals) holding student visas valid for more than 180 days or as per the stay stipulation endorsed on their visa should register themselves with concerned FRRO within 14 days of arrival in India.

Change of institution shall be allowed only if student has reasonable ground of insufficient infrastructure, paucity of facility, unavailability of the course of their choice or either of them.

Student should obtain a Restricted/Protected Area Permit (RAP/PAP) in case his/her educational institution falls under any of the Restricted/Protected areas.

In case of discontinuation of the course, foreigner should intimate the concerned FRRO immediately.

Tourism in India

If the foreigner's (other than Pakistani national) sole purpose is recreation, sightseeing, casual visit to meet friends or relatives, attending a short-term yoga programme, short duration medical treatment etc., he/she should arrive in India on a Tourist visa.

Foreign Tourists of such countries eligible for availing Tourist visa and traveling in groups of not less than 4 members under the auspices of recognized Travel Agency should obtain a Group Tourist visa to visit India.

Important Guidelines:

Maximum aggregate stay by a foreigner in India on an e-Tourist Visa or both should not exceed 180 days in a calendar year.

Continuous stay stipulation limit applicable after arrival in India on e-Tourist/ Tourist Visa.

e-Tourist/ Tourist visa shall not be extended and converted.

Foreign national (other than a Pakistani national) coming to India on any type of visa will be allowed to avail activities permitted under Tourist Visa.

Short term yoga programme means a yoga programme not exceeding 6 months duration and not issued with a qualifying certificate/ diploma etc.

There shall be a gap of at least 2 (two) months between two visits to India on a Tourist Visa in respect of nationals of Afghanistan, China, Iraq, Sudan, foreigners of Pakistan origin and Stateless persons.

Visa Free Regime

Exemption from the requirement of an Indian visa or Visa Free Entry into India is available for the Citizens of Nepal, Bhutan and Maldives.

Maldives

Visa free entry can be availed by Maldivians whose purpose of visit to India is exclusively for Business/Medical treatment/Tourism and the stay in India does not exceed a period of 90 days.

Key points to note:

Should be in possession of a valid Passport/Travel Document.

The 90 days period will be inclusive of all prior stays in India during a period of 6 months immediately preceding the Date of your arrival in India.

If the visit is for a period of more than 90 days, one should obtain a Regular visa.

Sign-On facility shall not be available to those Seamen who avail Visa free entry.

Nepal and Bhutan

Citizens of Nepal and Bhutan visiting India from Nepal or Bhutan by land or air are exempted from the requirement of Passport and an Indian visa. However, they are required to hold any such Government approved document authenticating their

Nationality which shall bear their Photograph along with information viz., Given Name, Last Name, Date of Birth, Nationality, Issuing Authority, Period of Validity etc.,

Key points to note:

Citizens of Nepal and Bhutan must be in possession of a valid Passport while entering/ exiting India from/ to a place other than their respective country.

Citizens of Nepal and Bhutan must be in possession of a passport and visa for India if he/she is entering India from China, Macau, Hong Kong and Pakistan.

Visa on Arrival (VoA)

Visa-on-Arrival facility is available for the nationals of Japan, Republic of Korea and United Arab Emirates (UAE); who intends to visit India for a period not exceeding 60 days for Business, Tourism, Conference and Medical purposes.

In case of UAE nationals, VoA will be available only to those who had earlier obtained e-Visa or regular sticker/paper Visa of India.

VoA is not available to the Citizens of Japan, Republic of Korea and UAE if the foreigner or either of his/her parents or grandparents (paternal/maternal) were born in, or were permanent residents of Pakistan.

Foreigners can avail the facility of Visa-on-Arrival at the International Airports in Bengaluru, Chennai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Kolkata and Mumbai.

Key points to remember:

Visa-on-Arrival shall be valid up to 60 days with double-entry facility.

VoA is non-extendable and non-convertible.

VoA facility is not available to holders of Diplomatic/Official Passports.

Work in India

Foreigners who desire to work in India should arrive on a valid Employment visa. Employment visas will be issued to those who are highly skilled and are qualified professionals, and are being engaged or appointed by an Indian Company/Organization/Industry/Undertaking or foreign Company/Firm/Organization engaged in execution of any project in India.

Foreigners who intend to work with a Non-Profit/Non-Governmental Organizations on a voluntary basis with or without honorarium (up to a ceiling of Rs. 10,000 per month) are also required to obtain an Employment (E-3) Visa.

Foreigner employed in any sector should draw a gross salary in excess of Rs. 16.25 lakhs per annum. However, certain foreigners who are employed in such sectors as notified by the GOI from time to time will be exempted from this annual floor limit.

Keep in mind!

A foreigner is required to enter India on a Business visa, if he/she is a promoter/owner of a company holding majority stakes/share holdings.

No change of employer shall be permitted during the currency of the employment visa. If the foreigner desires to change the employer, he/she has to leave the country and apply for a fresh Employment visa.

FRRO/ FRO concerned to be informed if the person discontinues the employment.

The foreign national must comply with all legal requirements like meeting the minimum salary payment of tax liabilities etc.

Foreigners are not allowed to work for more than one company simultaneously on an Employment visa.

Transit via India

Foreigners whose sole purpose to travel through India to a destination outside India requires a Transit visa. A Transit Visa will ordinarily be valid for a single journey and for entry within 15 days from date of issue, unless otherwise specified. In any case, the period of validity of a Transit visa will not exceed that of the visa for the country of ultimate destination.

A transit visa is only valid for direct transit, irrespective of the period of stay in the transit, which cannot be more than 3 days for each visit. For a stay in India beyond 3 days, a visa of the appropriate category should be obtained.

Persons in direct transit through India:

1.Travel by Air:

A Transit Visa is not required by a foreigner passing through, in direct transit by air, and travelling onward through India, provided he/she does not leave the specified precincts of the airport up to 24 hours, After 24 hours, a Transit Visa is required.

2. Travel by Sea:

A Transit Visa is not required by a foreigner who does not leave the ship while it halts at an Indian port. In case the foreigner intends to resume his/her journey from the same place by a scheduled Air service for which he/she holds a valid ticket, he/she will be allowed to leave the ship to proceed to the designated airport to catch his/her flight only with the prior approval of the competent authority.

Key points to remember:

If the journey through India is not performed within period of the validity of transit visa, a fresh transit visa will be required.

Validity of Transit visa is not extendable except in case of extreme emergency like strike, traffic, disruption, inclement weather, illness etc.

For a stay in India beyond 3 days, a visa of appropriate category should be obtained

Who are Foreigners/Persons of Indian origin (FIO)?

A foreigner is said to be a Foreigner of Indian Origin

If he/she at any time held an Indian passport; or

If he/she or either of his/her parents or grandparents or great grandparents, was born in, and was permanently resident in India, provided neither was at any time a citizen of Afghanistan, Bangladesh, China, Pakistan or Sri Lanka or any other country that may be specified by the Government of India from time to time.

Visa applicable to a FIO

If a Foreigner of Indian Origin (FIO) intends to visit India, Entry(X-1) visa is the most appropriate category of visa. However, they may obtain other categories of Indian visas depending on their purpose of visit.

Following categories of foreigners are eligible for X-1 Visa

Children/Spouse of Indian Citizens/Foreigners of Indian Origin (FIO)/ Overseas Citizen of Indian (OCI) card holders born in foreign countries.

French of Indian origin born in Puducherry, Mahe and Yanam.

Keep in mind!

Foreigners of Indian origin have to abide by all the laws and regulations of India.

Foreigners of Indian Origin should not hold Indian Voter ID, Family Ration Card etc.,

Any FIO holding X-1 visa if intends to take up employment in India should obtain prior permission from jurisdictional FRRO.

Surrender Certificate may be obtained from concerned Regional Passport Office (RPO) or the Indian Mission abroad at the time of surrendering the Indian passport.

In case of Death or Divorce of Indian/ FIO Spouse of foreigner on X-1 visa/OCI Card, Foreigner should immediately approach jurisdictional FRRO for further visa related matters.

Entry to Restricted/Protected Areas

Foreigners are not normally allowed to visit a Protected/Restricted Area in India until unless there are extraordinary reasons to justify such a visit. Foreigners who intend to visit the following places in India are required to obtain a Restricted/Protected Area Permit

Whole of Arunachal Pradesh

Parts of Himachal Pradesh

Parts of Jammu & Kashmir

Whole of Manipur

Whole of Mizoram

Whole of Nagaland

Parts of Rajasthan

Whole of Sikkim (partly in Protected Area and partly in Restricted Area)

Parts of Uttarakhand

Entire Union Territory of Andaman & Nicobar Islands

*RAP/PAP shall be required for all such places as notified by the Government of India from time to time.

How to obtain a RAP/PAP?

If the foreigner is residing outside India, he/she has to apply for the RAP/PAP permit through the concerned Indian mission at least 30 days in advance.

If the foreigner is residing/entered India, he/she has to apply for the RAP/PAP permit to the jurisdictional FRRO at least 15 days in advance.

Keep in mind!

Obtaining RAP/PAP permit does not give the foreigner full right/-access to that Restricted/Protected area, if it requires special permission from the additional in-charge of that particular establishment / installation / national park / island.

If any foreigner is found visiting a Restricted/Protected area without the Restricted/Protected Area Permit, action shall be taken under the relevant provisions of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025.

Entry to Prohibited Places

No foreigner shall, without the permission of the jurisdictional civil authority or the Registration officer, visit or reside in any prohibited place. Areas related to Defence Forces, vital installations and places of sensitive nature are categorised as prohibited places in addition to those defined or specified by the Central Govt from time to time.

How to obtain a Prohibited Area Permit?

Every foreigner intending to visit or reside in any prohibited place may submit an application for Prohibited Place permit electronically in the web portal.

If any foreigner is found visiting a Prohibited area without Permit, action shall be taken under the relevant provisions of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025.

The civil authority or the Registration Officer on the military officer in command, in case of a cantonment, may direct any foreigner to remove himself from the prohibited area/cantonment within such time as specified in such order.

Registration Authorities and their Jurisdiction:

The Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) works under the Bureau of Immigration, MHA. Besides overseeing immigration functions, the office looks after

various registration and visa related services for foreign nationals within its jurisdiction.

Across the country, there are fifteen FRRO offices. Their details are as under:

S. No. FRRO Office Jurisdiction (States/ UTs)

1	Ahmedabad	Gujarat, Daman and Diu, Dadra and Nagar Haveli
2	Amritsar	Punjab, Jammu & Kashmir
3	Bangalore	Karnataka
4	Calicut	Kerala (Kannur, Kasaragod, Kozhikode, Malappuram & Wayanad)
5	Chandigarh	Chandigarh and Haryana.
6	Chennai	Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Andaman & Nicobar Islands
7	Cochin	Kerala (Alappuzha, Ernakulam, Idukki, Kottayam, Palakkad & Thrissur) and Lakshadweep
8	Delhi	Delhi, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Gautam Buddha Nagar (Uttar Pradesh), Ghaziabad (Uttar Pradesh).
9	Guwahati	Assam
10	Hyderabad	Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Orissa
11	Jaipur	Rajasthan
12	Kolkata	Arunachal Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim, Tripura and West Bengal
13	Lucknow	Uttar Pradesh (except Gautam Buddha Nagar & Ghaziabad)
14	Mumbai	Maharashtra, Goa, Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh
15	Trivandrum	Kerala (Kollam, Pathanamthitta & Thiruvananthapuram)

Registration Requirements

Foreign Nationals visiting India are required to register with the Foreigner's Regional Registration Office (FRRO) or the Foreigner's Registration Office (FRO) as per their visa category and endorsement. Details are as under:

Foreign nationals entering India on a Student, Employment, Medical or Missionary visa where the visa is valid for more than 180 days, should register with the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO within 14 days of their arrival in India.

Business visa holders should register with the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO if their aggregate stay in India within the calendar year (Jan to Dec) exceeds 180 days or their continuous stay in India exceeds 180 days.

Foreign Nationals entering India on any type of visa (except on Official/ Diplomatic passport) will be required to register, if their aggregate stay in a calendar year or continuous stay on each entry exceeds 180 days.

Pakistani nationals are required to register with their local FRO within 24 hours of their arrival in India.

Note:

Children below 12 years of age do not require to register with the FRO/FRRO.

OCI cardholders are exempt from the requirement of registration.

Citizens of Nepal and Bhutan are exempt from the requirement of visa and registration.

All specific conditions and stipulations endorsed in the visa shall be adhered to at all times.

Non-compliance with registration rules shall result in legal consequences.

Special Categories

Pakistan: Every Pakistan national who enter India must register within 24 hours of arrival. This condition is exempted for those individuals who have 'Exemption from police reporting' endorsed on their visas. Also, Pakistan nationals on Medical visa should register within 7 days of arrival in India.

Afghanistan: Afghanistan nationals requesting for 'Stay Visa/ Residential Permit' shall apply online on <https://indianfro.gov.in>.

Bangladesh: Bangladesh nationals arriving in India on valid visas, and wishing to stay in India for a continuous period exceeding six months, will be required to register themselves with the respective FRRO/ FRO and obtain a residential permit within 14 days of their arrival.

Note:

Certain categories of Afghanistan/ Bangladesh/ Pakistan nationals staying in India are eligible for grant of Long Term Visas (LTV).

Detailed instructions on grant/ extension of LTV facilities are available on https://www.mha.gov.in/PDF_Other/AnnexVI_01022018.pdf.

These conditions are subject to change from time to time and the latest guidelines shall apply.

Visa Extension or Visa Conversion

Foreign Nationals who are unable to leave/ exit India within the validity of their visa due to justifiable reasons, should apply for the appropriate visa service on <https://indianfro.gov.in>.

Such visa services are available only to foreign nationals who are present in India.

This request/ application should be made within the validity of their current visa, allowing reasonable time for processing.

If the extension/ conversion of the visa/ permission to continue their stay is not granted within the validity of their current visa, they must depart from India. Failure to depart will be considered a willful illegal overstay and will be treated in accordance with the law.

Exit Permit

Loss of Passport: If a Foreign national loses his/her travel document (passport), he/she should promptly report the loss to the nearest police station and the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO. He/she should then approach the respective embassy or mission in India and apply for a new travel document. Upon obtaining the new document, he/she should apply for the necessary visa service on <https://indianfrro.gov.in>.

Adoptions:

Foreign nationals adopting an Indian child under CARA guidelines must obtain exit permits:

If the adopted child retains Indian nationality, then both parents need to take exit permits to travel out of India.

If the adopted child has acquired the nationality of the country to which either of the adoptive parent belongs, then both parents and the adopted child need to take exit permits to travel out of India.

Even if the parents are OCI card holders, the above mentioned conditions shall apply.

Foreign Nationals, except OCI card holders, are not permitted to commission surrogacy in India.

Overstaying / Violation of Visa Conditions: Foreigners who are overstaying in India or who have violated their visa conditions require Exit Permit to depart from India.

Police Clearance Certificate

A Foreign National staying in India, or who has previously stayed in India and wishes to apply for a Police Clearance Certificate (PCC) can do so by applying on www.indianfrro.gov.in/frro.

Note: Foreign nationals who are abroad and seeking an Indian PCC, may approach the Indian Mission/ Post in their respective country for obtaining a PCC.

Child born in India

Children born to foreigners in India (where either or both parents are foreigner), the foreigners concerned shall intimate electronically (via email), the birth of the child to the Jurisdictional Registration Officer/ FRRO within thirty days of the birth for availing visa services including grant of new visa and exit permission.

Foreign Nationals, except OCI card holders, are not permitted to commission surrogacy in India.

Every hospital, nursing home or any other medical institution shall furnish information in respect of any children born to foreigners (either or both the parents are foreigner) in their place within seven days of the occurrence of the birth, electronically (via email) to the Jurisdictional Registration Officer/ FRRO.

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Change of Passport

In case a registered Foreign National renews his/ her passport while staying in India, he/ she shall apply for "Change of Passport "service within 14 days to the jurisdictional FRRO/ FRO at <https://indianfro.gov.in>

Change of Address

In case of change of residential address, a Foreign National who is registered with the concerned FRRO/ FRO shall submit an application for change of address at <https://indianfro.gov.in>.

In case the new address comes under the jurisdiction of different FRRO/FRO, he/she shall apply for 'Transfer RC/RP' service on the link above.

Change of Academic Course

In case a foreign national on student visa needs a change in the course being undertaken by him/ her, he/ she should obtain a 'Change of Course' service from the jurisdictional FRRO/ FRO on <https://indianfrro.gov.in> within 14 days of changing the course.

Medical Exigency

Any foreigner (including Pakistani national) suffering from any minor medical condition which needs only OPD consultation can take treatment at any hospital on his/ her primary Visa.

A Pakistan national availing indoor medical treatment shall convert his/her primary visa to a medical visa.

Other Foreign Nationals shall apply for visa conversion to Medical visa if:

The medical treatment exceeds the stay stipulation of their primary visa; and/ or

The treatment of the disease requires an organ transplant.

Note: Visa conversion is subject to fulfillment of terms and conditions laid down by Ministry of Home Affairs.

Acquisition of Foreign Nationality by an Indian National:

India does not recognize the concept of dual nationality. Any Indian national who obtains a foreign citizenship ceases to be an Indian national from the day of acquisition of the new nationality.

Holding an Indian Passport/ acquiring an Indian Passport/ travelling on Indian Passport (excluding the grace period of 3 months after the acquisition of the foreign nationality) after acquisition of foreign citizenship (i.e. Naturalization certificate) constitutes an offence under the Indian Passport Act 1967 and attracts penalties.

Case 1: Indian national staying in India acquires a foreign nationality:

Obtain the passport of the new nationality.

Surrender the Indian passport, Indian Voter ID, Indian Ration card, and all other relevant Indian nationality documents.

Apply for visa services on <https://indianfrro.gov.in/> within 30 days of acquisition of foreign nationality.

Case 2: Indian national staying abroad acquires foreign citizenship but enters India on an Indian Passport:

Surrender the Indian passport, Indian Voter ID, Indian Ration card, and all other relevant Indian nationality documents.

Apply for visa services on <https://indianfrro.gov.in/> within 30 days of arrival in India.

UNHCR Card holder:

India is not a signatory to the 1951 United Nations Convention on the Status of Refugees and the 1967 Protocol thereof.

A foreign national who holds UNHCR card for Refugees/ Stateless may apply for appropriate visa service at [https://indianfrro.gov.in.](https://indianfrro.gov.in/) Applications will be evaluated by the jurisdictional FRRO.

Tibetan Origin person:

Tibetans who entered India before 30.05.2003 are eligible for a 'Long Term Stay' status and can obtain Registration Certificates from FRROs/FROs.

Tibetan nationals who arrived under Special Entry Permit (SEP) scheme after 30.05.2003 must register within 14 days, regardless of their visit's purpose or SEP validity.

Tibetan migrants intending to visit abroad shall travel only on the strength of the Certificate of Identity and Return Visa which may be issued by FRRO/ FRO. If the intended visit abroad requires absence from India for a period of more than 15 days, such Tibetan migrants would be required to take exit permission from the concerned FRRO /FRO.

Tibetans born in India to Tibetan Refugee couples and issued birth certificate by Tibetan Welfare Officer/ Tibetan Settlement Officer may be issued registration certificate on the basis of such certificate issued till January 01, 2003 clearly indicating on RCs that such birth certificates have been accepted specifically for the purpose of registration only.

After January 01, 2003, birth certificate issued by the competent authority under the Registration of Births and Deaths Act 1969 would be acceptable for the purpose of registration only.

Sri Lankan/ Tamil Origin

The refugee policy criteria for Sri Lankan refugees who arrive under unusual circumstances and are identified or registered as refugees by the Government of

Tamil Nadu shall be recognized as refugee and are subject to the following guidelines:

Registered Refugees in Designated Camps: Sri Lankan Nationals residing in designated refugee camps and holding Government of Tamil Nadu issued 'Sri Lankan Refugee cards', must adhere to the existing regulations of the camps and follow instructions updated through governmental orders from time to time.

Special Registries: Sri Lankan Refugees with Special Registration Certificates (under a scheme introduced by Government of India, 1999) issued by the concerned FRRO/FRO and who are permitted to stay outside of the designated Refugee campuses shall register their details with the jurisdictional FRRO/ FRO and renew their stay every six months.

Voluntary Return: Sri Lankan Refugees who arrived in India with valid travel documents and valid visas before January 9, 2015, and who choose to voluntarily return to their home country, are eligible for a waiver program. This program includes a waiver for penalties for overstaying.

These rules and regulations may be updated from time to time and the latest guidelines regarding the same shall apply.

Form III

Form III (earlier known as Form-C)

(1) Every keeper of accommodation shall require every foreigner, including an Overseas Citizen of India Cardholder, seeking accommodation in his premises to furnish the necessary particulars for recording, and sign, on his arrival at the accommodation, and at the time of his departure, the

date and time of his departure and the address to which he is proceeding, which shall be maintained by the keeper of accommodation electronically for a period of at least one year.

(2) The particulars referred to in point 1 shall at all times be available for inspection, on demand by Registration Officer, District Magistrate or police officer not below the rank of a Head Constable.

(3) All particulars shall be recorded by the keeper of the accommodation in English language, if he is so able, or otherwise, in an Indian language.

(4) If the foreigner does not understand English language, it shall be the duty of the keeper of the

accommodation, if so requested, to explain to the foreigner, the requirements of this rule.

(5) The keeper of the accommodation shall, as soon as may be but not beyond twenty-four hours, after the arrival of a foreigner, transmit a copy of duly filled in Form III, specifying the particulars furnished by the foreigner, electronically to the Registration Officer through the designated online portal or the mobile application mentioned below.

(6) The departure details shall also be transmitted as soon as may be but not beyond twenty-four hours, after departure of the foreigner, electronically to the Registration Officer through the designated online portal or the mobile application mentioned below

(7) For the purposes of this rule, —

(a) “accommodation” shall include any boarding house, club, dak-bungalow, rest house, hostel, paying guest house, sarai, rented accommodation, home stay, tents, hospital or other premises of like nature, premises of religious institutions, charitable trusts, any other trusts, public organisations or any other organizations or entity of social or religious or of public nature, furnished or unfurnished; and

(b) “sign” includes in respect of a foreigner who is unable to write, the marking of a thumb impression or other mark by means of which he is accustomed to attest a document.

Manner of report by hospital, nursing home or any medical institution:

(1) Every hospital, nursing home or any other medical institution providing medical, lodging or sleeping facility in their premises shall require every foreigner, including an Overseas Citizen of India Cardholder, to furnish the necessary particulars for recording, and sign, on his arrival at such hospital, nursing home or any other medical institution, and at the time of his departure, to furnish the date and time of his departure and the address to which he is proceeding, which shall be maintained by the hospital, nursing home or any other medical institution electronically for a period of one year.

(2) The particulars referred to in point 1 shall at all times be available for inspection, on demand by Registration Officer, District Magistrate or police officer not below the rank of a Head Constable.

(3) All particulars shall be recorded by the person in charge of hospital, nursing home or any other medical institution in English language, if he is so able, or otherwise, in an Indian language.

(4) If the foreigner does not understand English language, it shall be the duty of the person in charge of hospital, nursing home or any other medical institution, if so requested, to explain to the foreigner, the requirements of this rule.

(5) The person in charge of hospital, nursing home or any other medical institution shall, as soon as may be but not beyond twenty-four hours, after the arrival of a foreigner, transmit a copy of duly filled in Form III, specifying the particulars furnished by the foreigner, electronically to the Registration Officer through the designated online portal or the mobile application as mentioned below.

(6) The departure details shall also be transmitted as soon as may be but beyond twenty-four hours, after departure of the foreigner, electronically to the Registration Officer through the designated online portal or the mobile application as mentioned below.

(7) Every hospital, nursing home or any other medical institution shall furnish information in respect of any children born to foreigners (either or both the parents are foreigner) or death of any foreigner in their place within seven days of the occurrence of the birth or death, as the case may be, electronically to the Registration Officer in the designated online portal or the mobile application as mentioned below.

The link below will guide you to a Step-by-Step guide for filling Form-III:

How to register Form-III.pdf

<https://indianfrro.gov.in/frro/FormC> (Click here to register for Form-III)

Form-II

Form-II (earlier known as Form-A)

Every University and Educational Institution including school or any other institution, admitting any foreigner, including an Overseas Citizen of India Cardholder, shall furnish to the Registration Officer electronically, the information in respect of foreign students enrolled in their institution in Form II through the designated online portal or

the mobile application as mentioned below, within 24 hours from the time of admission and this shall be in addition to the Form III to be submitted in respect students provided with accommodation in a hostel.

Form-II can be submitted to the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO at <https://indianfrro.gov.in/sform/>.

Penalties

Overstay, non-registration, engaging in activities not in commensuration with the Visa granted, non-filing of requisite forms, and contravening any of the provisions or orders made under Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025 are subjected to penal/legal action as mentioned. Overstay, non-registration, engaging in activities not in commensuration with the Visa granted, non-filing of requisite forms, and contravening any of the provisions or orders made under Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025 are subjected to penal/legal action as mentioned.

As per various sections under Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, foreigners as well as Indian stake holders like carriers, hoteliers, educational institutions or hospitals where foreigner associate with, are liable for legal action, penalties ranging from 10000 to 3 lakhs for each offence, as well as imprisonment, if found violating any of the provisions of said act.

Violating the Indian visa norms is likely to affect the chances of obtaining entry into India and/ or Indian Visas in the future.

Foreigners Regional Registration Offices (FRROs) — Contact Directory

The Bureau of Immigration, Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, has established Foreigners Regional Registration Offices (FRROs) at key locations across the country. These offices are responsible for the registration of foreign nationals, issue and extension of visas, processing of Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) and Person of Indian Origin (PIO) card applications, and other immigration-related services. The contact details of all functional FRRO offices are listed below:

1. FRRO Ahmedabad

Officer-in-Charge: Smt. Sweta Shrimali, IPS

Office Address: 235, Ground Floor, HUDCO Bhawan, Iswar Bhuvan Road, Navrangpura, Ahmedabad, Gujarat.

Telephone: 079-26306606; Fax: 079-26306607

Email: frroamd[at]nic[dot]in; For Enquiry: afrro-boi[dot]ahd[at]nic[dot]in

2. FRRO Amritsar

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Manjeet Singh

Office Address: 208, Near Govind Park, Basant Avenue, Amritsar, Punjab.

Telephone: 0183-2560464; Fax: 0183-2500465

Email: frroasr[at]nic[dot]in

3. FRRO Bengaluru

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Santosh Babu K, IPS

Office Address: 5th Floor, A Block, TTMC, BMTC Bus Stand Building, K.H. Road, Shantinagar, Bengaluru – 560027.

Telephone: 080-22218195; 080-22218183; 080-22218110; Fax: 080-22218196

Email: frroblr-ka[at]nic[dot]in; For OCI/PIO Enquiries: ad-frroblr[at]mha[dot]gov[dot]in

4. FRRO Calicut (Kozhikode)

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Krishnaraj, IPS

Office Address: 6th Floor, Nikarthil Chambers, Opposite Sarvaram Bio Park, Mini Bypass Road, Arayidathupalam, Kozhikode, Kerala – 673004.

Telephone: 0495-2323550; 0495-2320650

Email: frro-clt[at]nic[dot]in; frrocal[at]nic[dot]in

5. FRRO Chandigarh

Officer-in-Charge: Dr. Deepak Siwach, IPS

Office Address: First Floor, BSNL Telephone Exchange, Sector 37D, Chandigarh – 160036.

Telephone: 0172-2991498; 0172-2993217; 0172-2991495

Email: frrochd[dot]support[at]mha[dot]gov[dot]in

6. FRRO Chennai

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. P. VE Arunshakthikumar, IPS

Office Address: Shastri Bhawan Annexe, Building No. 26, Haddows Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai – 600006.

Telephone: 044-28251721; Fax: 044-23454971; OCI Queries: 044-29510706

Email: chiochn[at]nic[dot]in; frrochn[at]nic[dot]in

7. FRRO Kochi (Cochin)

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Krishnaraj, IPS

Office Address: 2nd Floor, Airlines Offices Building, Cochin International Airport Ltd., Airport P.O., Kochi – 683111.

Telephone: 0484-2611654; Fax/Support Centre: 0484-2611652

Email: frrococ[at]nic[dot]in; Help Desk: frrococ-helpdesk[at]mha[dot]gov[dot]in; OCI Desk: oci[dot]frrococ[at]gov[dot]in

8. FRRO Delhi

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Deepak Yadav, IPS

Office Address: Level 2, East Block VIII, Sector 1, R.K. Puram, New Delhi – 110066.

Telephone: 011-26711384; Fax: 011-26711348; Support Centre: 011-26711443, 011-26713851; OCI Enquiry: 011-26184824, 011-26194311

Email: frrodli[at]nic[dot]in; Support Centre: frrodli[dot]support[at]nic[dot]in

9. FRRO Guwahati

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Inom Saikia

Office Address: LGBI Airport, Borjhar, Guwahati – 781015.

Telephone: 0361-2841466

Email: chioghy-asm[at]nic[dot]in

10. FRRO Hyderabad

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Venkata Appala Naidu Chintan, IPS

Office Address: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Bol OCR Complex, Shamshabad–Pahadishareef Road, Near GMR Township, Mamidipally, Shamshabad, Telangana – 501218.

Telephone: 040-29880374; 040-29880375

Email: frrohyd[at]nic[dot]in

11. FRRO Jaipur

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Ramesh Yadav, IPS

Office Address: Plot No. 01, Jhalana Doongri, Opposite Aranya Bhawan, Jaipur – 302004.

Telephone: 0141-2950422; 0141-2950423

Email: frro[dot]jaipur[at]gov[dot]in

12. FRRO Kolkata

Officer-in-Charge: Ms. Nidhi Rani, IPS

Office Address: 237, A.J.C. Bose Road, Kolkata.

Telephone: 033-22900549

Email: frrokol[at]nic[dot]in

13. FRRO Lucknow

Officer-in-Charge: Shri Harsh Singh, IPS

Office Address: FRRO, 12th Floor, Hall No. 1, Kendriya Bhawan, Sector-H, Aliganj, Lucknow.

Telephone: 0522-2432431; Fax: 0522-2432430; Registration & Visa Services: 0522-2987897

Email: frrolko[at]nic[dot]in

14. FRRO Mumbai

Officer-in-Charge: Ms. Niyati Thaker Dave, IPS

Office Address: Annex-II Building, 3rd Floor, Badruddin Tayyabji Marg, Behind St. Xavier College, C.S.T., Mumbai – 400001. (Landmark: near C.S.T. Railway Station, in the lane beside the Times of India Building.)

Telephone: 022-22621169; Fax: 022-22620721; Registration & Visa Enquiries: 022-22620446; PIO/OCI Enquiries: 022-22621167

Email: frromum[at]nic[dot]in

15. FRRO Thiruvananthapuram (Trivandrum)

Officer-in-Charge: Sh. Aravind Menon, IPS

Office Address: T.C. 30/1398-3, First Floor, Amrith Plaza, Nalumukku, P.O. Pettah, Thiruvananthapuram – 695022.

Telephone: 0471-2573512; Fax: 0471-2573514

Email: frrotvm[at]nic[dot]in

TRAVELLING ABROAD

General Information

1. The Citizens of India are required to obtain Immigration clearance both at the time of arrival as well as departure to/from India.
2. Indian Citizens are required to carry Valid Indian Passport, Valid Visa of the Destination Country and other clearances (if required) at the time of departure.
3. Passports of those Indian Citizens using e-Gates for their departure/ arrival to/ from India would not be stamped by Immigration. They may check their travel details from their Fast Track Immigration profile on [FTI-TTP Website](#)

Protector of Emigrants (POE) Offices in India

The Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India, has established Protector of Emigrants (POE) offices across the country to facilitate and regulate the emigration of Indian workers seeking employment abroad. These offices are responsible for issuing Emigration Clearance to eligible workers and ensuring their welfare. At present, POE offices are situated at the following thirteen locations:

1. Protector of Emigrants, New Delhi

Address: ISIL Building, VK Krishna Menon Bhawan, 4th Floor, 9 Bhagwandas Road, New Delhi – 110001.

Contact: Ph. 011-23382472, 23073908 | Email: poedelhi[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: The Delhi POE office exercises jurisdiction over the National Capital Territory of Delhi, the state of Uttarakhand, and select districts of Uttar Pradesh (Shamli, Muzaffarnagar, Meerut, Baghpat, Ghaziabad, Hapur, Bulandshahr, and Gautam Buddha Nagar). It also covers select districts of Haryana (Karnal, Jind, Panipat, Sonapat, Rohtak, Bhiwani, Charkhi Dadri, Jhajjar, Mahendragarh, Rewari, Nuh, Palwal, Gurgaon, and Faridabad) and select districts of Rajasthan (Alwar and Bharatpur).

2. Protector of Emigrants, Rae Bareli

Address: 1st Floor, Rudra Plaza, Hospital Road, Rae Bareli, Uttar Pradesh.

Contact: Ph. 0535-2211122/21 | Email: poerbl[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office has jurisdiction over the remaining districts of the state of Uttar Pradesh not covered under the Delhi POE office.

3. Protector of Emigrants, Jaipur

Address: CFC Building, RIICO, Sitapura Industrial Area, Sitapura, India Gate, Tank Road, Jaipur, Rajasthan.

Contact: Ph. 0141-2771528/29 | Email: poejaipur[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office has jurisdiction over the state of Rajasthan, excluding those districts that fall under the Delhi POE office.

4. Protector of Emigrants, Chandigarh

Address: 5th Block, Ground Floor, Room No. 27, Kendriya Sadan, Sector-9A, Chandigarh – 160017.

Contact: Ph. 0172-2741790 | Email: poechd[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office covers the states of Punjab and Himachal Pradesh, the Union Territory of Chandigarh, those districts of Haryana not falling under the Delhi POE office, and the Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir.

5. Protector of Emigrants, Mumbai

Address: 4th Floor, "Videsh Bhavan", Bandra Kurla Complex, Plot No. C-45, G Block, Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400051.

Contact: Ph. 022-26520023/26520024 | Email: poemumbai[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office has jurisdiction over the states of Gujarat, Maharashtra, and Madhya Pradesh, as well as the Union Territories of Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu.

6. Protector of Emigrants, Kolkata

Address: Room No. 18, A-Wing, MSO Building, 3rd Floor, DF Block, Salt Lake, CGO Complex, Kolkata – 700084.

Contact: Ph. 033-23343407 | Email: poekol[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office covers the states of West Bengal, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, and Sikkim, along with the Union Territory of Andaman & Nicobar Islands.

7. Protector of Emigrants, Hyderabad

Address: Regional Passport Office Building, 2nd Floor, 73, Red Cross Road, Shivaji Nagar, Secunderabad – 500003.

Contact: Ph. 040-27772557, 040-29556804 | Email: poehyd[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office has jurisdiction over the states of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana.

8. Protector of Emigrants, Chennai

Address: Rayala Towers, Tower 2, 4th Floor, Anna Salai, Chennai – 600078.

Contact: Ph. 044-29862069 | Email: poechennai1[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office covers the state of Tamil Nadu and the Union Territory of Puducherry (Pondicherry).

9. Protector of Emigrants, Thiruvananthapuram

Address: 5th Floor, NORKA Centre, Thycaud P.O., Thiruvananthapuram – 695014, Kerala.

Contact: Ph. 0471-2336625/26 | Email: poetvm2[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office has jurisdiction over the following six districts of Kerala: Thiruvananthapuram, Kollam, Pathanamthitta, Kottayam, Idukki, and Alappuzha.

10. Protector of Emigrants, Kochi (Cochin)

Address: Ground Floor, RPO Building, Panampilly Nagar, Kochi, Kerala.

Contact: Ph. 0484-2360187/2372040 | Email: poecochin[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office covers the remaining eight districts of Kerala — Ernakulam, Thrissur, Palakkad, Malappuram, Kozhikode, Wayanad, Kannur, and Kasaragod — along with the Union Territory of Lakshadweep.

11. Protector of Emigrants, Patna

Address: 5th Floor, A Block, Niyojan Bhawan, Bailey Road, Patna – 800001.

Contact: Email: poepatna[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office has jurisdiction over the states of Bihar and Jharkhand.

12. Protector of Emigrants, Bengaluru

Address: RPO Building, 8th Block, 80 Feet Road, KHB Games Village, Koramangala, Bengaluru – 560095.

Contact: Email: poebengaluru[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office covers the state of Karnataka and the state of Goa.

13. Protector of Emigrants, Guwahati

Address: RPO Building, Rani Bagan, Basistha Road, 3rd Bylane, Guwahati, Assam – 781028.

Contact: Ph. 8287020033 | Email: poeguwahati[at]mea[dot]gov[dot]in

Jurisdiction: This office has jurisdiction over the entire North-Eastern region of India, comprising the states of Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Manipur, Nagaland, and Tripura.

Countries requiring POE Clearance

As per the Emigration Act, 1983, Emigration Check Required (ECR) categories of Indian passport holders, require to obtain "Emigration Clearance" from the office of Protector of Emigrants (POE), Ministry of Overseas Indian Affairs for going to following 18 countries.

United Arab Emirates (UAE), The Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (KSA), Qatar, Oman, Kuwait, Bahrain, Malaysia, Libya, Jordan, Yemen, Sudan, Afghanistan, Indonesia, Syria, Lebanon, Thailand, Iraq (emigration banned), Iran.

However , the Ministry of Overseas Indian Affairs (Emigration Policy Division) have allowed ECR passport holders traveling abroad for purposes others than employment to leave the country on production of valid passport, valid visa and return ticket at the immigration counters at international airports in India w.e.f. 1st October 2007.

If the RPO has issued Indian passport either with endorsement of "Emigration Check Required" or no endorsement of "Emigration Check Required" in the passport, POE clearance is required only when there is "Emigration Check Required" endorsement in the passport.

Note: Seafarers travelling to join a vessel abroad, Nurses travelling to ECR countries, ECR and ECNR passengers travelling to Iraq are also required to obtain POE Clearance.

Seamen and e-Migrate

Directorate General of Shipping has launched e-Migrate system for seafarers keeping in view the difficulties faced by Indian seafarers who are recruited and placed on board foreign flag vessels by unlicensed Recruitment & Placement Service (RPS).

As per e-migrate system every Indian seafarer leaving Indian Seaport or Airport for joining ship requires to go through e-migrate system, any seafarer, except those exempted as per the guidelines, who attempts to join or joined ship without e-migrate would not be allowed to join/continue on ship.

For more details kindly visit website of Directorate General of Shipping at <https://www.dgshipping.gov.in/index.aspx>

(Ordinary Passport Holders)

As of the latest available information, Indian nationals holding ordinary passports are granted visa-free, visa-on-arrival, e-Visa, or combined VoA and e-Visa access to a total of 78 countries across the globe. The details of these facilities are as follows:

1. e-Visa Facility (25 Countries)

Indian passport holders are eligible to obtain an electronic visa (e-Visa) prior to travel for the following 25 countries: Argentina, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bahrain*, Benin, Colombia, Cote D'Ivoire, Djibouti, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan Republic, Lesotho, Malaysia, Moldova, New Zealand, Oman, Papua New Guinea, Russian Federation, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan, Turkey*, Uganda, Uzbekistan, and Zambia.

2. Visa-Free Facility (16 Countries)

Indian passport holders may enter the following 16 countries without requiring a visa: Barbados, Bhutan, Dominica, Grenada, Haiti, Hong Kong, Maldives, Mauritius, Montserrat, Nepal, Niue Island, Saint Vincent & the Grenadines, Samoa, Senegal, Serbia, and Trinidad & Tobago.

3. Visa-on-Arrival (VoA) Facility (26 Countries)

Indian passport holders may obtain a visa upon arrival in the following 26 countries: Angola, Bolivia, Cabo Verde, Cameroon Union Republic, Cook Islands, Fiji, Guinea Bissau*, Indonesia, Iran, Jamaica, Jordan, Kiribati, Laos, Madagascar, Mauritania*, Nigeria*, Qatar, Republic of Marshall Islands, Reunion Island*, Rwanda, Seychelles, Somalia*, Tunisia, Tuvalu, Vanuatu, and Zimbabwe.

4. VoA + e-Visa Facility (11 Countries)

The following 11 countries offer Indian passport holders both visa-on-arrival and e-Visa options, providing flexibility in how the visa is obtained: Kenya, Myanmar, Saint Lucia, Sri Lanka, Suriname, Tajikistan, Tanzania, Thailand, Vietnam, Ethiopia*, and Cambodia.

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Government of India imposes travel ban on Indian nationals planning to travel to countries which pose security threats and challenges to lives of Indian nationals. The countries with Travel restrictions are:

1. **Iraq:** As per travel advisory issued on February 18, 2020, Indian nationals should not travel to five provinces of Iraq, namely Nineveh, Salahuddin, Diyala, Anbar and Kirkuk due to security situation. As regards to Indian nationals travelling for employment to areas other than these five provinces, they must register on e-Migrate portal of GOI and inform Embassy of India in Baghdad or Consulate General of India in Erbil prior to travelling to Iraq.
2. **Yemen:** Government of India has imposed travel ban to Yemen for all Indian Passport holders vide MEA Gazette Notification F.NO: VI/401/1/11/2017 dated 26/09/2017.
3. **Libya:** Only essential travel is permitted to Libya for all Indian nationals vide MEA OM No: M-415/11/2022 dated 07/08/2024.

For further details, you are requested to kindly visit website of Ministry of External Affairs at www.mea.gov.in

Entry into Nepal

Identity documents required for Indian Citizens travelling to Nepal

- (a) A citizen of India entering Nepal by land or air does not require a passport or visa for entry.
- (b) A citizen of India, while travelling by air between India and Nepal, is required to be in possession of any of the following identity documents to establish his/ her identity as an Indian citizen:-

- I. Valid Indian Passport.
- II. Photo Identity card issued by the Government of India/State Govt./UT Administration in India to their employees or Election ID card issued by the Election Commission of India.
- III. Emergency certificate issued by the Embassy of India, Kathmandu valid for single journey for travelling back to India.
- IV. Identity Certificate issued by Embassy of India, Kathmandu valid for single journey for travelling back to India.
- V. Photo Identity Card issued by the Government of India/ State Government/ Union Territory Administration in India to their employees and dependent family members.
- VI. Minor children accompanied by Parents (having valid identity documents) may be allowed to travel between India and Nepal, if they are carrying one of the following documents (in original) establishing their identity, age and relation to the accompanying parent.
 - a. Aadhar card
 - b. Birth Certificate

- c. Photo Identity Certificate issued by School/College
 - d. Ration Card issued by the Government of India
-

Entry to Bhutan

Indian nationals visiting Bhutan do not require Visa. However, they will be issued an entry permit. 'Entry Permit' will be issued by the Department of Immigration in the Pedestrian Terminal at Phuentsholing on the basis of a valid Travel Document.

Tourists/ visitors from India are required to carry the following Travel Documents:

1. Original Indian Passport (with six months validity) or Original Voter ID card.
2. For children below 18 years, Original birth certificate (in English Language) or passport, and must be accompanied by a legal guardian.

For more details kindly refer to website of Department of Immigration (Government of Bhutan) www.doi.gov.bt

FOREIGNERS

General Information

1. Foreigners are advised to travel only through authorized Immigration Post. Ensure your passports are stamped by Immigration authorities.
 2. Foreigners require valid passport and visa (including Transit Visa, as applicable) for the destination country unless exempted.
 3. When is Exit Permit required:
 - a. Those issued with One-Time Travel Documents or Laissez Passer.
 - b. Those who have overstayed their stay stipulation or Visa validity period.
 - c. For inter-country/other adoptions of a child.
 - d. In case a foreign national who arrived in India with an Indian visa and subsequently gets an OCI card issued from Indian Embassy abroad based on his earlier application, the same OCI card cannot be used for departure from India. He should depart from India either within visa validity or obtain exit permit from jurisdictional FRRO. However, if the OCI card is issued in India from any FRRO, he can continue his stay and depart from India at his choice on the strength of newly issued OCI card.
 - e. For more please visit relevant section on this website under Registration Authority page.
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Travel requirements for Nepal Citizens

No Objection Certificate (NOC) mandatory for travelling to Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (KSA), Qatar, Kuwait, UAE, Oman, Bahrain, Iraq, Libya & Lebanon from India. NOC can be obtained from Embassy of Nepal in India. This regulation does not apply to those transiting India.

Pakistan- Exit via Authorized Exit Points

1. A Pakistan national who has a connecting flight to a third country at ICPs like Mumbai, Delhi or Chennai Airports should apply for a transit visa of India. In case a Pakistani national is returning by Air to Pakistan via any of the abovementioned Airports, he/she may obtain a double entry transit visa.
2. No visa is required for a Pakistan national directly transiting through an Airport/Seaport in India if his/her stay is only confined to the international transit area in Airport or Seaport.
3. Stay during a single entry on Indian transit visa should not exceed 36 hours.

Frequently Asked Questions.

1. **Do I have to report to police or register with Immigration authorities.**

Ans: Pakistan nationals on a transit visa need not apply for registration.

2. **Do I need a transit visa if I do not exit the airport?**

Ans: No, provided your stay is only at designated transit area of the airport.

3. **Can I enter India through Wagah/Attari land border with a transit visa and take an International flight from Amritsar or Delhi?**

Ans: No, You cannot.

4. **Can I avail a transit visa for entering by land border at Wagah/Attari and immediately drive to Amritsar or Delhi airport to board a flight to third country?**

Ans: No, You cannot.

STATELESS

Tibetan Origin

Tibetans Origin persons in India desirous of travelling abroad should possess all the following documents:-

1. Valid Certificate of Identity (COI)
2. Visa and necessary documentation of the destination country.
3. One year multiple entry Return visa issued by jurisdictional FRRO.
4. Exit Permit issued by jurisdictional FRRO (only if stay abroad is more than 15 days).

Tibetans in India should travel only on the strength of "Certificate of Identity" issued to them by Ministry of External Affairs, Govt of India. They require a "Return visa" to be eligible to return to India. In case there is an absence from India for more than 15 days, such Tibetans also need to obtain an Exit Permit from the jurisdictional FRRO, which is issued on the recommendation of Central Tibetan Administration (CTA). It may be noted that, if any Tibetan travels from India on any travel document other than the "Certificate of Identity" then they would be ineligible for long term status in India.

FAQ (Frequently Asked Questions)

1. What is an ETA?

Ans: ETA is an Electronic Travel Authorization. It allows the bearer access into the issuing country (India). ETA is NOT eVisa. When the bearer of ETA is allowed entry into India by the Immigration Officer, it becomes eVisa. eVisa will be stamped on the Passport of the foreigner at the designated ICPs on production of valid ETA.

2. What is the difference between "ETA Expiry date" and "Visa Expiry Date"?

Ans: ETA expiry date is the last date allowing bearer access into India. Visa Expiry Date is the last date permitted for the stay of foreigner in India subjected to any stay stipulation applicable.

3. What activities can I undertake on my Visa?

Ans: You are required to strictly adhere to the purpose of visit declared while submitting the visa application. Kindly refer to terms and conditions of your Visa.

4. Do I need to register with FRRO (Foreigners Regional Registration Officer) after arriving in India?

Ans: [Click here](#) for more details.

5. What is the difference between "Visa validity/Visa expiry date" and "Stay stipulation"?

Visa validity or Visa expiry date refers to the validity period during which the foreigner can stay in India on the strength of Visa subject to stay stipulations.

Stay stipulations are the rules which determine the number of days a foreigner may be permitted to stay in India on the strength of Visa. Stay

stipulations are of two kinds 1) Continuous stay in India from the date of last arrival. 2) Total Aggregate stay in India during the calendar year.

6. What is the maximum stay allowed on Tourist Visa?

Maximum stay by a foreigner in India on an e-Tourist Visa or paper Tourist Visa or both in one calendar year shall be restricted to 180 days.

7. What is a calendar year?

Ans: Calendar year refers to period from 1st January to 31st December of the current year.

8. What is “total aggregate stay in a calendar year” and “continuous stay”?

Ans: Total Aggregate stay refers to total period of stay of foreigner in India including multiple visits during the calendar year.

Continuous stay refers to period of stay of foreigner in India since his last arrival.

9. What is maximum duration of stay in Transit if I am not leaving the airport premises?

Ans: Foreigner may be permitted to stay in the designated area of the Airport for the purpose of travelling via connecting flight from India for a period of 24 hours. Transit Visa should be obtained if the waiting period is longer.

10. In case I reach the Arrival Immigration Counter few hours after the expiry of my ETA due to flight delays etc., will I be allowed entry into India on the ETA?

Ans: It may be considered on case to case basis by the Immigration Authorities.

11. In case I reach the Departure Immigration Counter few hours after the expiry of my Visa, will I be allowed to depart from India on that Visa?

Ans: It may be considered on case to case basis by the Immigration Authorities.

12. Can I undertake Tourism while on visit to India on Business/ Conference/ Medical Visa?

Ans: Foreign nationals who are granted a particular type of visa with reference to the purpose of visit shall be required to strictly adhere to the purpose of visit declared while submitting the visa application. However, a foreign national (other than a Pakistani national) coming to India on any type of visa will be allowed to avail activities permitted under Tourist Visa.

13. What is the procedure to obtain Political Clearance Letter issued by Ministry of External Affairs, as required for e-Conference Visa?

Ans: Kindly contact Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) for details.

14. What is the procedure to be followed if child is born in India to parents of foreign nationality?

Ans: Click here for details [child born in India](#)

Call Center Scams

Indian nationals are being lured by travel agents with false promises of lucrative job opportunities in marketing and administrative roles at major casinos in certain South East Asian countries. These agents offer high salaries and paid accommodation. Recent trends show that upon arrival they are tricked into working for call centres engaged in crypto related scams, fraud investment schemes and are engaged in cyber crime activities in those countries. Hence it is advised to observe due caution regarding this trend.

Employment in ECR countries without obtaining POE

Indian nationals holding ECR passports travelling to ECR countries on non-work Visas without POE certificate are advised to not take up Employment in ECR countries as they may be subjected to harsh work environment and are vulnerable to exploitation without any legal protection or recourse. Instances of travelling to a third country on tourist visa and further migrating to ECR Countries is observed as a trend to bypass the POE Certificates which results in exploitation of those ECR Passport holders in work environments.

Illegal migration to Western Europe

Indian nationals are advised not to be lured by travel agents offering opportunity for illegal migration to Western European countries via third country; As They may face exploitation, human trafficking and often seen forced to work in harsh work environments without any legal recourse. Further, they are also open to prosecution from the host country for their illegal entry/stay. Travellers are advised to verify the documents with care.

Commissioner, Bureau of Immigration

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Office Address: 7th Floor, Tower 'J', World Trade Centre (WTC), Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi - 110029

Telephone No: 011-26102622 (Telefax)

[click here](#) to contact your jurisdictional FRRO.

Contact Us

Support Centre, Bureau of Immigration

e-mail ID: support-boi[at]mha[dot]gov[dot]in (For any queries regarding Immigration, Visa etc)

Helpline Number: 011-24300666

Working hours: 0930 Hrs. to 1800 Hrs. IST (Indian Time) (Monday to Friday, except public holidays)

Forms

1. [Annual Salary Certificate format for Visa services](#)
 2. [Monthly Salary Certificate format for Visa services](#)
 3. [Bonafide Certificate format for Visa services](#)
 4. [Medical Certificate format for registration service](#)
 5. [Medical Certificate format for Visa service](#)
 6. [Mutual Consent format for Visa Service/ Exit Permit of minors](#)
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